

Hela

Project overview

Hela is a comprehensive mobile app designed to enhance the experience of global travelers. Created specifically for the tourism industry, Hela acts as a personalized travel assistant streamlining every step of a tourist's journey. From planning detailed itineraries and guiding tours, to booking hotels and discovering local blogs, Hela offers a suite of essential features tailored to the needs of foreign visitors. The app was thoughtfully designed to simplify travel logistics and empower users to explore new destinations with ease and confidence.

Problem statement

Traveling to a new country is exciting but the experience is often fragmented and stressful. Tourists are forced to juggle multiple apps and websites to plan their itinerary, book services, navigate unfamiliar places, and many more. While there are countless tools for individual travel tasks, there's no single, unified platform that brings everything together in one seamless, user-friendly experience. Travelers need an all-in-one solution that simplifies every step of their journey and empowers them to explore with confidence.

Solution — Hela

To address the fragmented and stressful nature of international travel, we created **Hela** — a comprehensive, all-in-one travel assistant designed to simplify every stage of a tourist's journey.

Hela combines essential travel tools into a single, seamless mobile and web platform, eliminating the need for users to juggle multiple apps and websites. With a focus on usability, personalization, and accessibility, Hela empowers travelers to explore new destinations with confidence and ease.

Key Aspects of the Solution:

- ✓ **Unified Experience:** All essential travel tools — from itinerary planning and hotel bookings to navigation and local insights — are integrated into one user-friendly platform.
- ✓ **Personalization:** The app provides tailored recommendations and content based on individual preferences and travel history.
- ✓ **Companion Website:** Hela extends beyond mobile, offering a responsive website for desktop users to plan and manage their trips anytime, anywhere.
- ✓ **Intuitive Design:** The interface is designed to be simple, visually engaging, and accessible for users from diverse cultural and linguistic backgrounds.
- ✓ **Stress Reduction:** By consolidating fragmented tasks into one cohesive experience, Hela

removes the common stress points of travel and helps users focus on making meaningful connections and lasting memories.

My Role- UI/UX Specialist

As the UI/UX Specialist for Hela, I was actively involved throughout the entire product development lifecycle from initial research to final design handoff.

Design Process

As the UI/UX Specialist for Hela, I was involved in every stage of the product design process — from uncovering user needs to delivering intuitive, high-fidelity interfaces. My approach followed a user-centered, iterative design methodology to ensure the final product was both functional and delightful to use.

1. Research & Discovery

Before diving into design, I led comprehensive research efforts to deeply understand the needs, frustrations, and behaviors of international travelers. This phase included:

- **User Interviews:** Conducted interviews with both frequent and first-time travelers to gather insights into common travel challenges and expectations.
- **Competitor Analysis:** Evaluated existing travel apps and platforms to identify market gaps and opportunities for improvement.
- **User Personas:** Developed detailed user personas based on research findings, which served as a constant reference point during the design process.

2. Ideation & Information Architecture

With a clear understanding of our users and competitors, I moved into the ideation phase:

- Mapped out **user flows** to visualize the key journeys within the app, such as itinerary creation, booking processes, and navigation assistance.
- Structured the **information architecture** to ensure intuitive navigation and logical grouping of features.

3. Wireframing & Low-Fidelity Prototyping

To quickly explore and validate design ideas, I created:

- **Low-fidelity wireframes** to outline the structure, layout, and core functionality of both the mobile app and companion website.

- Focused on simplifying complex travel tasks into clear, digestible steps.
- Gathered early feedback from stakeholders and users to iterate efficiently.

4. High-Fidelity Design & Interactive Prototypes

Once wireframes were refined, I transitioned to high-fidelity UI design:

- Developed polished, visually appealing screens aligned with a modern, accessible design system.
- Created **interactive prototypes** using Figma to simulate real user interactions.
- Prioritized accessibility, readability, and cultural inclusivity, ensuring the design resonated with a global audience.

5. Developer Collaboration & Design Handoff

Throughout the process, I worked closely with the development team to:

- Provide detailed design specifications and interactive prototypes.
- Participate in regular design reviews and stand-ups to ensure accurate implementation.
- Address any technical constraints while maintaining design integrity and user experience quality.

6. Usability Testing & Iteration

After development milestones, I facilitated usability testing sessions to:

- Validate design decisions with real users.
- Identify usability issues or friction points.
- Collaborate with the team to iterate on designs based on feedback and performance insights.